



The bitter realisation that, unlike my wealthier friends, I'll NEVER be able to retire

FEMAIL MAGAZINE STARTS PAGE 31

Trump's shock call with Putin to end the war – but will peace deal betray Ukraine?

■ US President says he expects to meet Russian leader in Saudi

■ Talks to stop the three-year conflict to start 'immediately'

By **Mark Nicol**
Defence Editor

DONALD Trump has started talks with Vladimir Putin to end the war in Ukraine.

On a dramatic day yesterday, the US President said he and his Russian counterpart had 'a lengthy and highly productive' phone call, during which they agreed that talks to end the conflict should start 'immediately'.

Any peace deal, which will effectively be imposed on Ukraine, is expected to include Russia keeping territory it has annexed since 2014, including the Crimean peninsula – a huge blow to Kyiv after three years of fighting for freedom.

President Trump's remarkable announcement, in which he declared 'the war must end' and said he expected to meet with Putin in Saudi Arabia, came hours after a series of stunning policy U-turns from US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth.

Speaking at a summit in Brussels, Mr Hegseth left senior military figures ashen-faced as he shattered Nato unity over Ukraine. His

Turn to Page 6



Final whistle: Rugby star Lawrence Dallaglio and wife Alice

Dallaglio and his wife to divorce after years of cheating claims

SEE PAGE 5